

Tony Yu

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Building cool things that hopefully others think are cool too :)

EDUCATION

University of California, Santa Cruz
B.S. Computer Science: Game Design

Santa Cruz, CA
June 2026

PROJECTS

StrengthAI | AI Workout Tracker

June 2026 – Present

- Innovated a **new way of logging exercises**: instead of searching from a list, users describe to the AI what they're doing and it builds the exercise, resolving **100+ logged exercise variants** to standard movements so progress tracks over time
- Built an **AI coach** that has answered **250+ workout related questions** from **50 active users**, backed by research and **guarded against direct health advice**
- Designed the **data model** and **fatigue-detection logic** across three signals: matched-load effort, cross-exercise patterns, and per-muscle volume, so the AI **flags a plateau for you to confirm** instead of acting on its own
- Owned **problem framing, prioritization, and the roadmap** solo, **cutting low-value features** (e.g., estimated 1RM, auto body weight logging) to keep the product focused on reducing decision fatigue

Bubble Mage | Steam Game

Jan 2026 – June 2026

- Designed level layouts and physics-based traversal mechanics for an open-world exploration game built in C#, then ran **5 iterative playtesting cycles with 40+ groups**, translating **player feedback** into balance and difficulty changes
- Built a **100+ person Steam wishlist waitlist** pre-launch, with full ownership of design, mechanics tuning, and audio implementation
- Led design on a **5-person team over 20 weeks**, facilitating roles, filling programming gaps, and keeping the team on **weekly deadlines** through launch
- **Pitched the game to a live audience of 500+**, and proactively recruited collaborators to grow the team, building buy-in and support beyond the initial scope of the project

EXPERIENCE

UCSC Athletics and Recreation

Santa Cruz, CA

Building Operations Attendant

Sep 2024 – Jun 2026

- Ran day-to-day gym operations, including opening/closing, equipment setup, and safety and cleanliness standards, for a facility serving **1,000+ students and staff daily**
- Redesigning equipment maintenance and inventory procedures, **reducing equipment downtime by ~40%**, and performed routine repairs and inspections
- Supported students, faculty, and staff with facility orientations and inquiries; **recognized by management** for customer service and problem-solving

Boys & Girls Clubs

Team Leader

San Francisco, CA

Sep 2019 – Jun 2021

- Led a **team of staff** delivering daily programming for **25+ club members**, adapting plans on the fly to keep sessions engaging and on schedule
- Set clear expectations and **delegated responsibilities across the team**, coaching staff through day-to-day challenges and stepping in to resolve issues before they affected programming
- Collected feedback from club members and staff to find gaps in daily programming, then **prioritized and rolled out changes** based on what they needed most

Technical Skills: Python, C#, JavaScript, SQL, React, HTML/CSS, Shell Scripting, Unity, **LLM/API Integration**, Secure Backend Development, GitHub, Pure Data, OSC, Reaper

Product Skills: Problem Framing & Positioning, Data-Informed Feature Design, User Research & Iterative Testing, Roadmapping & Prioritization, Cross-functional Technical Collaboration